

Here's how to use the Windows Troubleshooter to fix a printer showing 'offline' status:

Running the Printer Troubleshooter

Step 1: Open the Troubleshooter

- Press **Windows + I** to open Settings
- Go to **System → Troubleshoot → Other troubleshooters**
- Scroll down to find **Printer** and click **Run**

(On Windows 10, go to Settings → Update & Security → Troubleshoot → Additional troubleshooters → Printer)

Step 2: What Happens When It Runs

The tool automatically runs through a sequence of diagnostic checks. Here's what it does and what it tells you:

1. Detecting the Problem It scans your system and lists all connected printers. It then identifies which one has the issue and flags the "offline" status, telling you something like: *"Windows has detected a problem with Printer"*

2. Checking the Print Spooler Service It verifies whether the **Print Spooler** is running. If it's stopped or stuck, the tool will report this and offer to restart it automatically. It informs you: *"The print spooler service was not running — attempting to restart."*

3. Checking Printer Connectivity It checks whether the printer is properly connected — via USB, network, or Bluetooth — and reports whether the device is detected at the hardware level. For network printers, it may report: *"Printer not responding on the network."*

4. Reviewing Driver Status It checks if the installed printer driver is functional, outdated, or corrupt. It may report: *"Driver issue detected"* and offer to reset or reinstall it.

5. Checking Default Printer Settings It verifies whether the **"Use Printer Offline"** mode is accidentally enabled and can disable it, reporting: *"Printer was set to offline mode — this has been corrected."*

Step 3: Results & Report

Once finished, the troubleshooter shows a **summary screen** with:

- A list of **issues found**
- **Actions taken**

- Issues it **couldn't fix** automatically, with guidance on next steps
 - An option to **view detailed information** showing a full log of every check performed
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If the Troubleshooter Doesn't Fix It

The tool itself may tell you to try these manual steps:

Suggestion	What to Do
Check physical connection	Re-plug USB or re-join Wi-Fi network
Update drivers	Visit manufacturer's website
Remove & re-add printer	Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Printers
Check "Use Printer Offline"	Printer properties in Control Panel